Summary

Memorandum on Topic Drift Watch.

A standing watch on agent reliability started collecting unrelated outages.

Topic Drift Watch flags a digest item when its embedding similarity to the topic seed falls below 0.42.

The threshold caught 17 off-topic items in May while missing 2 items the editor still wanted.

Operator decision: Keep the similarity gate, and send borderline items to an editor rather than suppressing them..

Evidence

Method note: An editor labeled May digest candidates as on-topic or off-topic, and the gate was compared with those labels.

Reported result: Off-topic precision was 0.94 and on-topic recall was 0.90 at the 0.42 cutoff.

Limits of the evidence: The seed was a single paragraph, so a topic that legitimately shifts vocabulary will look like drift.

Open questions: Should the seed be updated automatically after an editor accepts a borderline item?
Risk review: Severity medium: A fixed threshold can drop a genuine development that uses new terminology.

Recommended action: Queue borderline items for a quick editor decision instead of auto-dropping them..